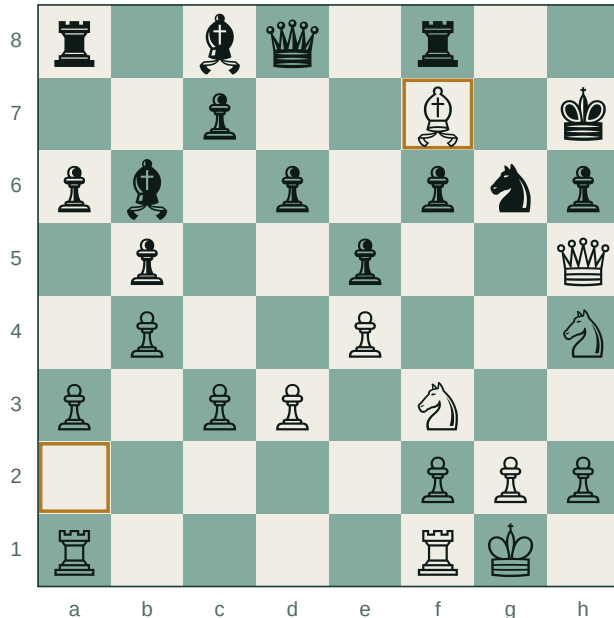


Active defensive resources: Black, move 17

Active defensive resources

Black to move



Previous move: 17.Bxf7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

17...Nf4 18. Bg6+ Kg7 19. Nf5+ Bxf5

17...Nf4 The knight moves from g6 to f4. Recorded reply: **18.Bg6+**.

18...Kg7 The king moves from h7 to g7. Recorded reply: **19.Nf5+**.

19...Bxf5 The bishop captures the knight on f5.

At the end, nominal material is White 33 / Black 35 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3:** the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on g1. Absolute pin: pawn on f2.